

VISUAL ARTS

OVERVIEW

Visual arts courses at the Grade 11 and 12 level focus on studio work and critical analysis of a wide range of art works. Students apply the elements and principles of design with increasing skill and creativity to produce art works that communicate emotions or comment on issues. They apply their skills using an array of media, including alternative media, and current technologies, to create two- and three-dimensional art works for a variety of purposes.

Students create increasingly complex art works that integrate the fundamental components of design known as elements (colour, form, line, shape, space, texture, and value). Students continue to explore design principles (balance, contrast, emphasis, harmony, movement, proportion, rhythm and repetition, unity, and variety), organizing or arranging these principles in increasingly sophisticated ways to produce visual effects.

Students develop their understanding of how art works reflect and affect the history, values, and beliefs of various societies and cultures. By experiencing a wide range of art works, including the rich heritage of Canadian art, students enhance their understanding and appreciation of the range and significance of artistic expression.

The expectations for visual arts courses are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students enhance their ability to apply the creative process (see pages 15–17) to create and present original art works. Students use tools, technologies, and the elements and principles of design with increasing sophistication to create art works for a variety of purposes. Throughout, they document their approach to each stage of the creative process in a portfolio, which they can use for reflection.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** Through the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22), students reflect on their responses to and assess art works, developing a deeper understanding of themselves and the communities in which they live. By exploring the context of various art works, students expand their awareness of past and present societies. They explore opportunities for continuing engagement in postsecondary study and careers of personal interest in arts-related fields.
3. ***Foundations:*** In this strand, students enhance their understanding of conventions, techniques, and processes that people use to produce visual art works. Students refine their specialized vocabulary, engage in responsible practices when creating and presenting art works, and investigate increasingly complex ethical and legal issues associated with visual arts.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.
The list of approved focus courses for Visual Arts can be found at:
www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Visual Arts, Grade 11

University/College Preparation

AVI3M

This course enables students to further develop their knowledge and skills in visual arts. Students will use the creative process to explore a wide range of themes through studio work that may include drawing, painting, sculpting, and printmaking, as well as the creation of collage, multimedia works, and works using emerging technologies. Students will use the critical analysis process when evaluating their own work and the work of others. The course may be delivered as a comprehensive program or through a program focused on a particular art form (e.g., photography, video, computer graphics, information design).

Prerequisite: Visual Arts, Grade 9 or 10, Open

A. CREATING AND PRESENTING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** apply the creative process to create a variety of art works, individually and/or collaboratively;
- A2. The Elements and Principles of Design:** apply the elements and principles of design to create art works for the purpose of self-expression and to communicate ideas, information, and/or messages;
- A3. Production and Presentation:** produce art works, using a variety of media/materials and traditional and emerging technologies, tools, and techniques, and demonstrate an understanding of a variety of ways of presenting their works and the works of others.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use various strategies, individually and/or collaboratively, to generate, explore, and elaborate on ideas and to develop and revise detailed plans for the creation of art works that address a variety of creative challenges (*e.g., use brainstorming, concept webs, and/or group discussions to formulate original ideas for thematic works and/or works of personal expression; use research and discussions with a partner to explore and elaborate on ideas; use diagrams, notes, and/or outlines to help them formulate detailed plans for the art work; revise their plans on the basis of reflection*)

Teacher prompts: “What sources might you consult to help you elaborate on your ideas?”
“Have you reflected on how your plan addresses each stage of the creative process? Do you need to revise your approach to any of these stages?”

- A1.2** apply the appropriate stages of the creative process to produce and revise two- and three-dimensional art works using a variety of traditional and contemporary media (*e.g., explore, experiment with, and refine their use of a variety of media; choose a medium/media appropriate for their planned art work; reflect on the effectiveness of preliminary versions of their work; revise their art work on the basis of reflection and useful feedback*)

Teacher prompt: “How have you revised your planned art work as a result of your experimentation with media and techniques? In what ways does your completed work differ from your original vision?”

- A1.3** document their use of each stage of the creative process, as well as varied and extensive research, in a portfolio that includes art works created for a variety of purposes (*e.g., ensure that their portfolio includes evidence of idea generation and elaboration, research, investigation, planning, exploration, experimentation, and revision; include a variety of works created for different purposes*), and review and reflect on the contents of their portfolio to determine how effectively they have used the creative process

Teacher prompts: “What evidence does your portfolio provide of research during the imagination/innovation and exploration stages of the creative process?” “Does your portfolio include representative samples of your work?”

A2. The Elements and Principles of Design

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** explore how elements and principles of design can be used to convey emotion and enhance personal expression, and use a combination of these elements and principles to create two- and three-dimensional art works that express personal feelings and communicate

specific emotions to an audience (e.g., *explore how variations in line, value, form, proportion, and emphasis can be used to convey various emotions; adapt their findings to enhance expression in their art work*)

Teacher prompt: “How has Marjane Satrapi used black-and-white line drawings to enhance the emotional aspects of her autobiographical graphic novel *Persepolis*? How could you adapt aspects of her use of elements and principles and apply them to enhance your own works of personal expression?”

A2.2 apply elements and principles of design as well as art-making conventions to create art works that comment and/or communicate their personal perspective on issues related to social justice or the environment (e.g., *use line and value in a drypoint etching that integrates satire or symbolism to comment on an issue such as poverty, child labour, or discrimination*)

Teacher prompt: “What type of symbols might you use in a work about poverty? Why do you think these symbols would be effective? How might you use conventions such as juxtaposition or exaggeration in the same work?”

A3. Production and Presentation

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 explore and experiment with media, including alternative media, and current technologies, and use them to create a variety of art works (e.g., *use media such as digitally enhanced photographs, transparencies, and/or found objects when creating a collage; create a mixed-media image reflecting their personal identity or cultural heritage*)

Teacher prompts: “How might you combine alternative and traditional media to create a collage?” “How might you use digital technologies to enhance the creativity of your art work?”

A3.2 explore a range of traditional and current materials, technologies, techniques, and tools used by visual artists (e.g., *Claude Monet’s use of optical colour mixing; Andy Warhol’s use of silkscreens; George Segal’s use of plaster bandage; Jean-Paul Riopelle’s use of a palette knife for impasto application of paint; Daphne Odjig’s use of interconnecting black lines*), and adapt and apply them to create original art works

Teacher prompts: “Explain how you can affect a viewer’s impression of your work by altering the materials, techniques, or media.” “How might you adapt some of the techniques used by Monet in his Giverny paintings to enhance your own landscape painting?”

A3.3 describe appropriate standards and conventions for the presentation of different types of visual art works, and apply these standards and conventions when preparing their art works for presentation (e.g., *ensure that their work is signed, labelled, dated, matted, and/or mounted, that their three-dimensional work can be displayed safely, that the appropriate digital presentation technology is available and in working order*)

Teacher prompts: “How and why does the intended venue for your work change the way you prepare the work for display?” “In what ways can variations in matting or mounting affect the audience’s response to your work?”

A3.4 explain how variations in where and how art works are displayed (e.g., *as public art, in private and public galleries, on the Internet, in the mass media, in virtual and traditional museums, as transient art works*) can affect the impact and meaning of the works and the size and type of audience they reach

Teacher prompt: “In what circumstances would a traditional gallery be the best place to exhibit a work of art? When might a virtual gallery be more appropriate? Why?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** demonstrate an understanding of the critical analysis process by examining, interpreting, evaluating, and reflecting on various art works;
- B2. Art, Society, and Values:** demonstrate an understanding of how art works reflect the society in which they were created, and of how they can affect both social and personal values;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** describe opportunities and requirements for continued engagement in visual arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** analyse their initial response to art works (*e.g., describe their initial reaction to an art work and determine which specific aspects of the work and their personal experience led to their reaction*)

Teacher prompt: “What do you see when you look at this art work for the first time? What do you think this art work is about? Why? Do you think everyone would share your opinion or understanding? Why or why not?”

- B1.2** deconstruct the visual content and the use of elements and principles of design in their own art work and the work of others (*e.g., identify individual elements and principles and aspects of the visual content in an art work, interpret their function, and analyse how the artist has manipulated them to create impact, emphasis, mood, movement, and meaning; compare The Abduction of the Daughters of Leucippus by Peter Paul Rubens to the cover of a contemporary comic book about an action hero, with reference to the artists’ use of colour, line, shape, value, balance, and emphasis*)

Teacher prompt: “What differences are there between the landscapes of Homer Watson and those of Emily Carr with respect to the artists’ use of elements/principles such as colour, value, shape, proportion, and emphasis? What impact do these differences have on the mood or meaning of the works?”

- B1.3** explain, with reference to particular works, both historical and contemporary (*e.g., J. M. W. Turner’s Rain, Steam, and Speed: The Great Western Railway; Maya Lin’s Vietnam Veterans Memorial*), how knowledge of an art work’s cultural and historical context, achieved through research, has clarified and enriched their understanding of the work’s intent and meaning

Teacher prompts: “In what ways has your research on the American role in the Vietnam War contributed to your understanding of the intent of Maya Lin’s design for the *Vietnam Veterans Memorial*?” “Does learning about the Industrial Revolution change the way you interpret Turner’s painting? Why or why not?” “Why does knowledge about the role of Canadian women in World War II enhance a viewer’s understanding of Paraskeva Clark’s *Parachute Riggers*?”

- B1.4** describe and reflect on the qualities of their own art works and the works of others, and evaluate the effectiveness of these works, using a variety of criteria (*e.g., the works’ ability to convey a message or emotion; their technical merit; their stylistic qualities; the use of technique and successful manipulation of media/materials; the connection between form and message*)

Teacher prompt: “When you reflect on the stylistic qualities of this work, which do you think are successful? Why? Are there any that you think are not effective? What might you change to increase their effectiveness?”

B2. Art, Society, and Values

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 analyse the function and social impact of different kinds of art works in both past and present societies (*e.g., the use of art works for ritualistic and religious purposes; for social and/or political commentary; as propaganda; as symbols of economic or social power; to commemorate people and/or historical events; to instruct*)

Teacher prompts: “What was the purpose of the murals Diego Rivera was commissioned to create in Mexico in the 1920s? What impact did his works have in Mexico and the rest of North America?” “Why and how was the Taj Mahal built?”

B2.2 explain, on the basis of research, ways in which various art works are a response to and a reflection of the society in which they were created (*e.g., how available technologies and materials affect artists’ work; how artists have responded to persecution or social injustice; how changing gender roles are reflected in art works*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways did the invention of the camera change the course of painting?” “In what ways does Gerald McMaster’s work reflect his experiences as a Cree living in Canada?” “How did the ‘Reversing Vandalism’ art show come about? What does it reveal about social mores?”

B2.3 reflect on and explain how creating and analysing art works has affected their personal identity and values and/or changed their perceptions of society and social issues (*e.g., with reference to their emotional awareness and their ability to express themselves; their awareness of stereotypes; their understanding of the meaning*

of objects and symbols associated with a variety of cultural groups; their awareness of and relationship to their physical environment; their position on social issues such as censorship, discrimination, inequality)

Teacher prompts: “Has analysing art works created by First Nation artists affected your awareness of Aboriginal culture in Canada? Why or why not?” “In what ways has creating art works enhanced your ability to express your feelings or point of view?”

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 identify a variety of careers in fields related to visual arts (*e.g., advertising, art direction for theatre or films, art therapy, costume design, graphic design, industrial design, museum or gallery curation, photojournalism*), and describe the skills, education, and training they require

B3.2 describe, on the basis of research and investigation, a variety of personal opportunities in their community in cultural or other fields related to visual arts (*e.g., opportunities within their school or community to promote the arts by finding new venues for visual arts displays; opportunities to organize or create an art installation in a public space; the availability of grants, funding, or sponsorship for public or school-based art works that explore a social theme*)

B3.3 describe, on the basis of investigation, a variety of local, national, and global arts-based organizations, and identify ways they could become involved with one or more of these organizations (*e.g., community art councils; websites that promote the arts*)

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, elements, principles, and other components related to visual arts;
- C2. Conventions and Techniques:** demonstrate an understanding of conventions and techniques used in the creation of visual art works;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of responsible practices related to visual arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

C1.1 demonstrate an understanding of the elements and principles of design, and use terminology related to these elements and principles correctly and appropriately when creating or analysing art works (*e.g., when describing how they have used elements and principles in a sculpture to convey a sense of movement*)

C1.2 explain terminology related to a variety of techniques, materials, and tools (*e.g., additive and subtractive techniques, blazing, gesso, intaglio, layering, palette knife, scumbling, transfers, single-lens reflex [SLR] cameras, software used to edit digital photographs*), and use this terminology correctly and appropriately when creating, analysing, and/or presenting art works

C1.3 using appropriate terminology, explain the creative process and describe in detail the critical analysis process, with particular reference to the role of deconstruction in the latter process

Teacher prompt: “What kinds of decisions about materials, techniques, and style does the artist have to make when deciding to create an art work? What kinds of information does the viewer need to explore when trying to deconstruct the art work?”

C2. Conventions and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 demonstrate an understanding of a wide variety of techniques that artists use to achieve a range of specific effects (*e.g., techniques used to create the illusion of depth and perspective and to create texture on different surfaces; the use of additive and subtractive sculpture, layering, positive and negative space, and relief to create effects*)

C2.2 demonstrate an understanding of a variety of conventions used in visual arts (*e.g., allegory, expressive exaggeration, juxtaposition, synectics; conventions associated with heroic, narrative, naturalistic, propaganda, realistic, and satirical art*), and explain how they are used in different types of art works

Teacher prompt: “Why is allegory often used in propaganda art or works of social or political criticism?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 demonstrate an understanding of legal and ethical issues related to the appropriation of images, materials, or ideas, or to the display of art works (*e.g., issues related to censorship, to the appropriate and inappropriate display of art works*), and apply legal and ethical practices when appropriating images, materials, and/or ideas

to create art works (e.g., provide a suitable credit to the original artist when appropriating images and/or ideas; show sensitivity in the use of images or conventions associated with other cultures)

C3.2 demonstrate an understanding of health and safety issues and conscientious practices associated with the use of materials, property, techniques, tools, and technologies in visual arts (e.g., the appropriate use of aerosol products, utility knives, printing presses, electrical tools, computers; appropriate precautions to take when exposed to physical and chemical hazards), and apply these practices when creating and/or presenting art works

C3.3 demonstrate an understanding of how the production and presentation of art works can affect the environment (e.g., in small groups, prepare a role play to illustrate the environmental consequences of improper use or disposal of hazardous or toxic materials), and apply environmentally responsible practices when creating, presenting, and promoting art works

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important to know the source and content of the materials and media you are using?” “What types of materials should you avoid using in your art works because their sourcing, processing, and/or disposal can damage the environment?”